

HISTORY BATTLEFIELD TOUR

COURSE TEXTBOOK

Enquiry: Thursday 1st October – Saturday 3rd October 2026

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L1: Pre-Trip Information

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

10th Sep

Parent Briefing Meeting

16:15 in the School Hall. Attendance is highly recommended to receive final itineraries and ask any questions.

1. Pre-Trip Briefing

Please ensure all pupils have the following items packed in a suitable overnight bag (no hard suitcases if possible, to maximize coach storage space):

- **Valid Passport** (handed to staff on the morning of departure)
- **GHIC / EHIC Card** (valid and in-date)
- **Sturdy Walking Boots** or waterproof shoes (we will be walking through muddy trenches)
- **Waterproof Coat** (Belgian weather is unpredictable)
- **Small Rucksack** for daytime use on the coach
- **Euro Currency** (approx €30-€50 maximum for snacks and chocolates)
- **Refillable Water Bottle**

L2: Day 1: Thursday 1st October 2026

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

14:30

Essex Farm Cemetery & Dressing Station

Historical introduction to wartime medical care and Commonwealth war graves.

16:00

Hooge Crater Museum & Trenches

Museum visit focusing on First World War artefacts, preserved trenches, and field medicine.
[Visit official website.](#)

20:15

Supervised Free Time

Downtime in communal areas.

17:45

Arrival at Peace Village

Accommodation check-in and safety briefing. [View hostel details.](#)

06:15

Departure from School

Travel via Jet Connect executive coach to Folkestone.

11:20

Eurotunnel Crossing

19:15

Study & Reflection Session

Guided review and workbook completion.

15:15

Langemarck German Military Cemetery

Guided visit exploring the contrasting design of German burial sites.

09:00

Folkestone Eurotunnel Terminal

Check-in and security boarding.

1. Day 1 Itinerary

Today we travel to Belgium to begin our exploration of the Ypres Salient. The itinerary is packed with important historical sites.

Transit to Calais (clocks go forward 1 hour).

13:00

Depart Calais

Coach journey to the Ypres Salient.

22:00

Curfew & Room Checks

All students in rooms for the night.

18:15

Evening Meal

Dinner followed by room allocation and settling in.

L3: Day 2: Friday 2nd October 2026

Chronological Domino Flowchart

*Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).*

20:30

Return to Accommodation

Supervised free time.

08:00

Breakfast

Provided at accommodation.

13:00

Tyne Cot British Cemetery

Guided visit to the world's largest Commonwealth war cemetery.

22:00

Curfew & Room Checks

All students in rooms for the night.

17:30

Return to Peace Village

Downtime and preparation for evening event.

09:45

Sanctuary Wood & Preserved Trenches

Exploration of original trench systems (sturdy footwear advised).

11:30

Supervised Lunch Stop

Stop in Ypres to purchase packed lunch and snacks.

09:00

Depart for Battlefield Sites

Board coach for full day of guided study.

09:15

The Brooding Soldier

Visit to the Canadian memorial at St Julien (First Gas Attack, 1915).

14:15

Lijssenthoek Visitors Centre & Cemetery

Study of casualty clearing stations and battlefield medicine. [Visit official website.](#)

19:00

Menin Gate, Ypres

Attend the historic 20:00 Last Post Ceremony, including official wreath laying by nominated students. [Last Post Association](#).

15:45

Passchendaele Museum (Zonnebeke)

Immersive museum tour and dugout experience. [Visit official website](#).

18:00

Evening Meal

Dinner at accommodation.

1. Day 2 Itinerary

Today is a full day of guided study across the Ypres Salient, concluding with the Last Post Ceremony at the Menin Gate.

L4: Day 3: Saturday 3rd October 2026

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

13:30

Poperinge Town Hall

Visit to preserved death cells and military justice sites.

17:50

Eurotunnel Crossing

Calais to Folkestone (arrives 17:30 UK time).

08:00

Breakfast & Packing

Breakfast, room handover, and loading coach.

11:20

Talbot House, Poperinge

Tour of the famous British soldiers' rest house and club. [Visit official website](#).

14:30

Depart for Calais

Return journey to Eurotunnel terminal.

20:00 approx.

Return to School

Arrival back at Meoncross School for collection.

09:15

Menin Gate & Ramparts Walk

Daytime study of memorial panels and walk to Ypres Ramparts Cemetery.

10:30

Ypres Town Square

Supervised visit to a traditional Belgian chocolatier.

12:45

Lunch in Poperinge

Supervised lunch stop in the town centre.

1. Day 3 Itinerary

Our final day involves exploring the town of Poperinge, an important rest center for British soldiers, before beginning our journey home.

L5: Private T. J. Franklin

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Home

Stubbington Connection

Lived at Meadow Cottage, Chark

Memorial

Stubbington War Memorial

Commemorated in the village center.

Resting Place

Menin Gate, Ypres

Killed 29th April 1915 holding an exposed line on the Frezenberg Ridge.

1. The Life and Fall of Private T. J. Franklin

Service Number: 8560

Regiment: 1st Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: Alverstoke, Hampshire, in about 1893.

He was the son of George Franklin (an Army Pensioner and farm labourer) and Mary Ann Jane Franklin. The family lived at Chark Cottage in Stubbington, and later moved to Meadow Cottage, Chark, Lee-on-the-Solent. By 1911, Thomas was serving in Wellington Lines, Aldershot.

Enlisted at Gosport. He was deployed to the Western Front in August 1914, earning the 1914 Star. He was killed in action on **29th April 1915** during the Second Battle of Ypres. His battalion was holding an exposed section of the line on the Frezenberg Ridge (east of St Julien) to cover an Allied withdrawal, enduring intense German shelling and the first ever military poison gas attacks.

Commemorated on the Ypres (Menin Gate) Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L6: Private W. Ayling

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Resting Place

Menin Gate, Ypres

Killed 9th July 1915 during heavy trench mortar bombardment.

Home

Stubbington Connection

Lived in Stubbington Lane; worked as a Baker Boy

Memorial

Stubbington War Memorial

Commemorated in the village center.

1. The Life and Fall of Private W. Ayling

Service Number: 9330

Rank: Private (commemorated on the Holy Rood Memorial Tablet as a Lance Corporal, though official war records register him as a Private).

Regiment: 1st Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: About 1895 in Hindhead, Surrey.

He was the second son of Horace Ayling (a head cowman) and Annie Ayling. The family moved to Stubbington around 1907, residing in a crowded 13-person household in Stubbington Lane, where William worked as a local baker boy.

Enlisted at Winchester. He crossed to France in August 1914, earning the 1914 Star. He was killed by shell fire on **9th July 1915** (only a few months after his battalion comrade, Private Franklin). His company was heavily shelled and hit with trench mortars during an action to relieve captured enemy trenches north of Ypres.

Commemorated on the Ypres (Menin Gate) Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L7: Private S. Muckett

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Home

Stubbington Connection

Lived at Brown's Farm; worked as a Grocer's Errand Boy

Resting Place

Tyne Cot British Cemetery

Killed 20th September 1917 during the Battle of Menin Road Ridge.

Memorial

Stubbington War Memorial

Commemorated in the village center.

1. The Life and Fall of Private S. Muckett

Service Number: 12977

Rank: Private (listed as a Corporal on the Holy Rood Memorial, but registered as a Private in official war records).

Regiment: 15th (Service) Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: 26th December 1895 at Titchfield.

He was the son of William Muckett (a farm labourer) and Elizabeth Muckett. They lived at Pound Knap, Crofton, and Brown's Farm, Stubbington, where Sydney worked as a grocer's errand boy, before relocating to Melville Gate, Stubbington. His sister Louisa Annie and brother Frank both married into the local Rye family.

Enlisted at Fareham in 1914. He was killed in action, aged 21, on **20th September 1917** during the Battle of Menin Road Ridge. His battalion went over the top south of Ypres, advancing rapidly under fire to clear a German strongpoint at Java Avenue.

Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L8: Private A. Rye

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Resting Place

Tyne Cot British Cemetery

Killed 26th September 1917 at Polygon Wood.

Home

Stubbington Connection

Lived at Lower Crabthorne; Nurseryman

Memorial

Stubbington War Memorial

Commemorated in the village center.

1. The Life and Fall of Private A. Rye

Service Number: 22926

Regiment: 14th Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: 1897 at Forest Side, Sussex.

He was the youngest child of Charles Rye (a farm labourer) and Jane Rye. The family lived at Stroud Green, Stubbington. By 1911, Arthur was living at Lower Crabthorne, Hill Head, working as a local nurseryman. His sister Alice married Frank Muckett (brother of Private Sydney Muckett).

Enlisted at Fareham. He was killed in action, aged 21, on **26th September 1917**—only nine days after his brother-in-law's brother, Sydney Muckett, was killed. His battalion attacked near the Menin Road, advancing through Tower Hamlets under heavy mist to consolidate their objectives.

Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium, on the exact same panels as Sydney Muckett (neither body was ever recovered).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L9: Lance Corporal A. Ward

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Memorial

Stubbington War Memorial

Commemorated in the village center.

Home

Stubbington Connection

Lived at Balmoral, Gosport Road

Resting Place

Tyne Cot British Cemetery

Killed 14th October 1918 advancing in thick mist.

1. The Life and Fall of Lance Corporal A. Ward

Service Number: 17568

Regiment: 15th (Hampshire Yeomanry) Battalion, The Hampshire Regiment

Born: 1896 in Alverstoke.

He was the son of Hugh Ward (a Royal Navy Coastguard and yacht steward) and Bertha Kathleen Ward. The family lived at 6 Coastguard Cottages, Hill Head, and later Balmoral, Gosport Road, Lee-on-the-Solent. His younger brother, Horace Vivian Ward, was also killed in action.

Enlisted in Portsmouth. He fought on the Western Front, in Italy, and returned to France in March 1918. He was killed in action, aged 23, on **14th October 1918**—less than a month before the Armistice. During the final Allied advance from Gheluwe towards Courtrai, Belgium, his battalion advanced through thick mist under a harassing barrage to overcome German pillboxes.

Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L10: Private C. Warland

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Task: The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to **draw arrows connecting the boxes** in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A → Event B → Event C...).

Memorial

Stubbington War Memorial

Commemorated in the village center.

Resting Place

Tyne Cot British Cemetery

Killed 4th October 1917 taking Juniper Trench.

Home

Stubbington Connection

Lived at Canford

1. The Life and Fall of Private C. Warland

Service Number: T/202335

Regiment: 3/4th Battalion, The Queen's (Royal West Surrey) Regiment

Born: 1897 at Richmond, Surrey.

He was the son of John Alfred Henry Warland (a sporting journalist, author, Secretary of the Lee-on-the-Solent Golf Club, and parish councillor) and Louise Clara Warland. The family lived at Canford, Lee-on-the-Solent.

Enlisted in Richmond, Surrey. He was killed in action, aged 20, on **4th October 1917** during an assault south-east of Polygon Wood. His battalion advanced across the Polygonebeek marsh to capture Juniper Trench and a blockhouse under a continuous and heavy German artillery barrage.

Commemorated on the Tyne Cot Memorial, Belgium (no known grave).

Biographical information courtesy of the Stubbington and Hill Head History Society.

L11: The Final Teacher Challenge

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Synthesize learning from various historical sites into a cohesive understanding of the Great War.

As we conclude our journey through the Ypres Salient, it is time to bring the stories of the fallen back home. Your final challenge is to choose one of the local heroes we investigated and write a short memorial speech that could be read aloud at the Stubbington War Memorial on Remembrance Sunday.

Your speech must:

- State who they were and where they lived.
- Describe the conditions they faced on the battlefield.
- Explain why their sacrifice, and the sacrifice of their generation, must never be forgotten.